

Analysis of the dimensions of psychological resilience among children and their perception of the divorce crisis: a descriptive and analytical study¹

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Keywords: psychological resilience, divorce crisis, children.

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Abstract:

Title: Analyzing the Dimensions of Children's Psychological Resilience and Their Perception of the Divorce Crisis: A Descriptive-Analytical Study. This study seeks to analyze the dimensions of children's psychological resilience and their perception of the divorce crisis, using a descriptive-analytical approach. The study aims to identify the main components of the concepts of "psychological resilience" and "divorce crisis" from the children's perspective, paving the way for the development of scientific measurement tools whose psychometric properties can be subsequently verified. To achieve these objectives, the theoretical framework and previous literature were reviewed to answer two main questions: What are the dimensions of the Children's Psychological Resilience Scale? What are the dimensions through which children perceive the divorce crisis, and what are its behavioral and emotional indicators?

The study concluded with the development of a theoretical model for the Children's Psychological Resilience Scale consisting of three main dimensions: self-efficacy, social relationships, and emotional resilience. A model for perceiving the divorce crisis was also developed, including dimensions related to behavioral indicators such as academic decline and emotional indicators such as sadness and loneliness. Based on these findings, the study recommends the design of preventive treatment programs based on positive psychology to enhance psychological resilience and offers practical recommendations for parents. The study also proposes a series of future studies to explore new aspects in this field.

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Introduction:

Love and security are fundamental human needs, crucial for healthy development across the lifespan. Within the family unit, these needs are met by fostering a psychologically secure environment that is instrumental in the cultivation of values and overall well-being. However, children in families affected by parental divorce face a significant disruption to this foundational sense of security. The unresolved conflicts and emotional turmoil preceding and following a divorce can give rise to a host of negative emotions that, if left unaddressed, may escalate into serious psychological and behavioral disorders (Boss, 2022). Research consistently shows that divorced individuals often experience feelings of anger, inadequacy, and loneliness, which heighten their vulnerability to depression and anxiety (Karela & Petrogiannis, 2018). These challenges are amplified for children, who must navigate a sudden shift in their family life. In this context, psychological resilience emerges as a vital protective factor, enabling children to cope with the profound stress of parental separation (Ashkenazi & Renea, 2008). Its development is essential for preventing long-term psychological illnesses resulting from negative experiences (Masten & Obradovic, 2008). A foundational study by Greeff and Van Derwe (2004) identified key variables linked to resilience in divorced families, emphasizing that resilience is not merely innate. It's shaped by environmental and personal factors like social support and coping mechanisms (Shin & Kim, 2005). Accordingly, this research seeks to provide an in-depth analysis of the specific dimensions of psychological resilience among children and their perception of the divorce crisis.

Objectives:

1. To identify the dimensions that comprise the Children's Resilience Scale.
2. To identify the items that measure each dimension of children's psychological resilience.
3. To identify the dimensions of the divorce crisis as perceived by children.
4. To identify the behavioral indicators for each dimension of the divorce crisis as perceived by children.
5. To identify the emotional indicators for each dimension of the divorce crisis as perceived by children.

Importance of the research:

1. The research provides a model for the axes and items of a children's psychological resilience scale.

2. Its psychometric properties can be verified for use in subsequent scientific research.
3. To encourage the use of psychological resilience in coping with the divorce crisis in children in family therapy programs and therapeutic interventions.
4. To provide a basis for future research exploring new aspects related to psychological resilience and coping with the divorce crisis in children.

Methodology Used: Descriptive-Analytical Methodology. The reason for choosing this method is that it provides a sound scientific basis for the next stage of the research, which will be to verify the validity and reliability of the constructed scales. It includes several aspects:

1. The descriptive aspect: describes the phenomena under study and defines their dimensions and indicators, rather than testing hypotheses or proving causal relationships. It describes the components of "psychological resilience" and "divorce crisis."
2. The analytical aspect: the process of identifying axes and items based on the theoretical framework and literature review represents an analysis of concepts to transform them into measurable items.
3. The constructive process: this method supports the constructive process of the scale, where items are generated and classified under specific axes. This is an essential step prior to the stage of verifying the psychometric properties.

The research questions can be formulated as follows:

Question 1: What are the dimensions that comprise the psychological resilience scale for children, and which items measure each dimension?

Question 2: What are the dimensions through which children perceive the divorce crisis, and what are the behavioral and emotional indicators for each dimension?

Dedicated Terms and Their Operational Definitions:

1. **Psychological Resilience:** A child's ability to adapt positively and recover from the stresses and challenges they face following their parents' separation. Psychological resilience is measured through the child's responses and behavior, such as their ability to interact socially, continue participating in school activities, and display positive emotions or recover from negative emotions associated with the divorce.

2. **Divorce Crisis:** The set of negative emotional, social, and behavioral changes a child experiences as a result of their parents' separation. This crisis is measured by observing its manifestations in the child, such as feelings of

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anxiety or sadness, declining academic performance, aggressive behavior, or social withdrawal.

3. Children: Individuals between the ages of 6 and 12 who are experiencing parental separation or divorce. This age group is defined based on its developmental characteristics, as they have the ability to express their feelings clearly, and their behavior and impact on the divorce can be directly observed.

Theoretical Framework and Previous Studies:

Psychological Resilience Contributes to Children's Coping with Parental Divorce:

Ashkenazi and Renea's study, "Psychological Resilience and Coping in Children of Divorce," aimed to determine whether locus of control, coping style, and negative appraisal, as well as the family environment, act as protective or risk factors for adult children of divorce and reduce differences in psychological symptoms between individuals from divorced and non-divorced families. It was also determined whether locus of control, coping style, negative appraisal, and the family environment interact with parental marital status in predicting depression and anxiety. Indicators of depression and anxiety in children and adults from divorced families were examined using the following instruments:

1. Adult Internal and External Control Scale
2. Family Environment Scale
3. Anxiety Scale
4. Adult Cognitive Error Questionnaire

The results indicated the following:

1. Many individuals are negatively affected by parental divorce, but there is greater variability in emotions and behavior among children from non-divorced families compared to their peers from intact families.
2. Adolescents are particularly affected by parental divorce, as puberty is a particularly vulnerable life stage, during which individuals undergo numerous identity and lifestyle transitions.
3. Therapeutic interventions are needed for young children and youth from divorced families to reduce the risk of future mental illness and abnormal behaviors, given that the study showed the following:
4. Among young children and youth from divorced families, there were low levels of family cohesion, high levels of dysfunctional coping, and high levels of negative appraisal, which predict greater depression.
5. When comparing participants from divorced and non-divorced families, participants from divorced families demonstrated greater family conflict, less family cohesion, and high levels of dysfunctional coping and emotional focus, which uniquely predict greater anxiety. Achieving

marital compatibility is related to a high level of education. Education and awareness among spouses of the importance of intellectual convergence and mutual understanding between the two parties contribute to their level of marital compatibility and, consequently, the level of psychological compatibility of the children. Proper life planning and setting common goals also contribute to providing an opportunity for spouses to cooperate, which impacts their marital compatibility and reduces domestic violence, including psychological violence against children (Rabab Al-Sayed Abdel Hamid Mashal, 2016, 288). Abused wives who are exposed to varying degrees of marital violence are incompatible to varying degrees due to interrelated factors such as age difference, number of children, and independent housing. Violence is reflected in the children, affecting their psychological development and accumulating negative emotions over time. The children are also affected by the mother's suffering and her decreased ability to psychologically adapt to this family environment, which is bitter and destructive to the family due to its lack of love, affection, mercy, and altruism. A study was conducted by (Fatima Al-Zahraa Bin Mujahid, Khadija Hamou Ali, 2022) on a sample of 43 wives. The descriptive approach was used in this study, and a scale of marital violence and marital compatibility was applied to them. The results of the study showed that there is an inverse relationship between marital violence and marital compatibility, where the higher the marital compatibility, the lower the marital violence and vice versa. The study also found that there are differences in the degree of marital violence among incompatible wives due to the age difference and residential independence.

Negative identification in children in divorced families.

(Chethik, M., Dolin, N., Davies, D., Lohr, R., & Darrow, S., 2021, pp. 121-138)

Negative identification is an unconscious process adopted by a child to protect themselves from the pain of divorce. Due to the conflict between parents, the child tends to side with one parent completely (usually the parent they feel is more vulnerable or wronged), adopts a negative view of the other parent, and may even reject any relationship with them. This negative identification is not merely a choice; it is a complex psychological defense mechanism. The child believes that if they do not choose a side, they will feel guilty or have divided loyalty, causing them even greater psychological pain. This behavior leads to a distortion of the child's identity, as they adopt negative feelings toward one of their parents, preventing them from building a healthy and balanced relationship with both. The mother's role goes beyond simply providing

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support; it extends to helping the child get rid of negative feelings. Intertwined, and building a healthy relationship with both parents.

The Importance of Understanding the Emotions of the Divorced Mother and Her Children:

The concept of "negative identification" is essential to understanding how divorce affects children's inner feelings. It emphasizes the importance of the divorced mother understanding her own feelings and those of her children:

1. Understanding the Child's Complex Emotions: The divorced mother must realize that her child's rejection of his other parent or his adoption of her viewpoint toward him may not be the result of genuine hatred, but rather a defense mechanism. This deep understanding prevents the mother from feeling victorious or encouraging this behavior, as it is harmful to the child's psyche in the long run.

2. The Mother's Responsibility to Break the Negative Attachment: When the divorced mother understands that the child is suffering from "negative identification," it becomes her responsibility to help the child break this attachment. She can achieve this by:

3. Avoiding tarnishing the father's image: Regardless of the problems between the parents, the mother should avoid speaking badly about the father in front of the children.

4. Encouraging the Relationship with the father: She should encourage the child to spend time with his father and show respect for his presence in the child's life.

5. The Impact of Repressed Emotions on Children: This research demonstrates that unprocessed emotions in parents can lead to a negative attachment. It is transmitted to the children subconsciously. If a divorced woman harbors anger or resentment toward her ex-husband, this anger may be passed on to the child, who translates it into "negative identification" as a way to express sadness or anger that they themselves cannot understand.

6. Building a Healthy Identity for the Child: A mother's understanding of her own feelings and working to address them is the first step to preventing the child from internalizing her negative feelings. When the child frees herself from "negative identification," she can build an independent, healthy identity and become capable of forming balanced relationships with both parents, strengthening her psychological resilience in the face of future challenges.

Elaine Brown's model for understanding the divorce process as a complex journey that transcends legal proceedings: (Brown, E. M., 1976) Brown's model demonstrates that divorce is a multifaceted process, and that understanding each stage emotionally, socially, and psychologically is key to recovery for the divorced woman and her children. Elaine Brown (1976)

proposed a model for understanding the divorce process as a complex journey that transcends legal proceedings.

Model divides divorce into six interconnected stages:

Emotional divorce, legal divorce, economic divorce, co-parenting divorce, social divorce, and finally, psychological divorce.

Brown's model highlights the importance of understanding the emotions associated with divorce for the divorced woman and her children by dividing the experience into separate but interconnected stages.

For the divorced woman:

Emotional divorce first: The model emphasizes that emotional detachment often occurs before any legal action. Understanding this stage helps the divorced woman realize that feelings of sadness, failure, or even liberation are a normal part of a long process. This realization gives her a timeframe for recovery, rather than feeling like she has to move on once the legal process is over.

The comprehensive recovery journey: Divorce doesn't end with the signing of the papers. The divorced woman must understand that she will go through other stages, such as reorganizing her financial life (economic divorce) and changing her social network (social divorce). Awareness of these stages prepares her psychologically to deal with the upcoming challenges and reduces her feelings of loneliness and uncertainty.

For children:

Understanding the stages of co-parenting: Brown's model focuses on co-parenting as one of the stages. This means that parents, even after separation, must cooperate to raise their children. If the mother understands this stage well, she can separate her personal feelings toward the father from her role as a mother, ensuring the continuity of the relationship between the children and their father.

- **Psychological divorce for children:** Like adults, children also go through a psychological divorce as they must adjust to the new reality and accept that their parents will no longer be together. A mother's understanding of her own feelings helps her be more empathetic to her children's feelings. You can be a model of strength and resilience, helping them overcome the stages of grief, anger, and confusion, thus enhancing their psychological resilience. A study conducted by Alaa Abdul Razzaq Al-Turki (2016) aimed to explore the relationship between childbirth anxiety and psychological resilience among pregnant women in Damascus. The study included 150 pregnant women from a maternity hospital in Damascus.
- **The researcher used two scales:** one to measure childbirth anxiety, which she designed, and the other to measure psychological resilience. Although the original text does not mention the results of the study, the

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primary goal was to determine whether there was a relationship between these two variables. This study focuses on pregnant women, but it sheds light on the concept of the relationship between psychological resilience and the ability to cope with anxiety resulting from a major life event and a radical change. This concept can be applied to children facing parental divorce. Divorce, like childbirth, is a major life-changing event and can generate intense anxiety about the future.

Children in divorced families often feel anxious about:

1. Their future with their parents.
2. Changing residence or school.
3. Maintaining their relationships with both parents.

In this context, psychological resilience acts as a protective factor. Just as psychological resilience helps pregnant women cope with the anxiety of childbirth and deal with physical and psychological changes, it helps children understand that divorce is not the end of the world, but rather part of the challenges that can be overcome.

Parents and professionals can help build psychological resilience in children by:

1. **Encouraging them to express their feelings:** Helping children understand that their feelings are normal and that talking about them is healthy.
2. **Building a sense of control:** Involving children in age-appropriate decisions, such as choosing activities or decorating their new rooms, enhances their sense of control over their lives.
3. **Focusing on strengths:** Helping children recognize their abilities and skills, which enhances their self-confidence and resilience.

In this way, children can not only overcome the future anxiety imposed by divorce, but also emerge from the experience stronger and more prepared to face future challenges.

Psychosocial support groups chosen and approved by divorced women:

A study (Øygard, L., Thuen, F., & Solvang, P., 2000, pp. 149-164) examined the effectiveness of support groups for divorced people, using a qualitative approach to understand participants' experiences. The study focused on how these groups helped individuals cope with divorce. Results showed that participants felt significantly improved in their ability to manage their emotions, developed a deeper understanding of their experience, and acquired new communication skills. The study also

confirmed that sharing experiences with others going through similar circumstances reduces feelings of loneliness and isolation.

Connecting the findings to the importance of understanding emotions for divorced women and their children, this study highlights a vital point: that processing emotions related to divorce is not an individual journey, but rather a collective process that can be enhanced by support groups.

This has powerful implications for divorced women and their children.

For divorced women:

1. Naming and normalizing emotions: In support groups, divorced women learn that their feelings of sadness, anger, or even relief are normal. When she hears similar stories, she realizes she's not alone, which reduces her feelings of guilt or shame. This mutual understanding of feelings is the first step toward healing.

2. Acquire new skills: Groups not only help vent feelings, but also provide practical tools for dealing with them. The divorced woman learns how to communicate effectively with her ex-husband and how to cope with the stresses of raising children alone.

For the children:

1. Reflection of the mother's psychological state: When the divorced woman attends support groups and learns how to understand and manage her emotions, this positively impacts her children. A mother who feels inner peace is better able to provide a stable and supportive environment for her children.

2. Break the cycle of negative emotions: If the divorced woman suppresses her negative emotions, she often unconsciously transmits them to her children. But when she learns how to express these feelings in a healthy way, she breaks this cycle. This helps the children understand that negative emotions can be managed, which strengthens their psychological resilience and reduces their anxiety about the future.

3. Set a positive example for dealing with crises: A mother who seeks support does not show weakness, but rather strength. By participating in support groups, she provides her children with a practical model for dealing with crises. She teaches them that asking for help is not shameful, and that true strength lies in facing difficulties rather than ignoring them.

This study confirms that understanding emotions is not merely an individual process, but a journey that can be supported by the environment. Participation in support groups can be a crucial tool for recovery if chosen by the divorced woman, and is truly beneficial and supportive, not only for her but also for her children, who draw their strength from her emotional stability. However, it is important that she be content and happy with her presence in these groups, of her own choosing, and that they provide the support she needs and do not

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impose psychological pressure on her. However, imposing support groups or assistance without the divorced woman's consent or without her feeling comfortable and happy increases her suffering and psychological pain, which is reflected in her children.

The necessity of a divorced woman acknowledging her feelings and enabling her to recover to set a healthy example for her children:

The study (Haber, J., 1990, pp. 228-234) presents a family systems model to understand the divorce process and its impact on the "loss of self" in individuals. The model suggests that divorce not only affects the spouses, but also disrupts the entire system, leaving every family member, including the children, in a state of confusion and loss of identity. This study emphasizes that divorce is not just an event, but a systemic crisis that impacts the entire family.

Understanding this dynamic is crucial for the divorced woman and her children. For the divorced woman:

- **Understanding "loss of self":** The divorced woman may feel lost or have lost part of her identity after the divorce, because her identity was tied to the role of "wife." This study confirms that this feeling is normal. Understanding these feelings helps her be more compassionate with herself and realize that the journey to recovery requires a complete rebuilding of herself, not just overcoming the pain.
- **Dealing with Complex Emotions:** Divorce triggers conflicting emotions such as anger, sadness, and liberation. Recognizing that these feelings are related to a loss of self helps the divorced woman process them healthily. Instead of suppressing them, she can allow herself to experience them as part of the rediscovery process.
- **For Children:** 1. Understanding the Child's Identity Crisis: Children also feel a loss of part of their identity, as their family is no longer "complete." They may feel they belong to "two families" instead of one, creating feelings of confusion and anxiety.
- A mother's understanding of her own feelings gives her the ability to empathize with her children's feelings and explain that their feelings of confusion are normal.
- **Avoiding Blame:** The family systems model explains that problems are not the responsibility of one person. When a divorced woman understands this, she avoids placing all the blame on herself or her ex-husband, which prevents her from passing on this guilt to her children. 3. Building a New **Family Identity:** A mother must help her children build a new family identity, where each member has a clear and stable role. This helps them

regain a sense of security and confidence, and strengthens their psychological resilience to face future anxiety.

- This study confirms that divorce is a systemic crisis that affects all family members. Understanding the feelings of loss of self is the first step toward empowering a divorced woman to recover and setting a healthy example for her children, helping them rebuild their identity with confidence after the crisis.

Stages of Divorce from a Psychological Perspective: "Kaslow's Model":

Kaslow's model demonstrates that understanding emotions is not only part of recovery, but is its foundation. It helps divorced women manage their psychological journey and enables them to guide their children through the divorce crisis, ensuring they emerge from the experience with greater emotional resilience. Florence Kaslow's research describes the stages of divorce from a psychological perspective. The research divides the divorce process into four overlapping stages: emotional divorce, legal divorce, economic divorce, and co-parenting divorce. Kaslow emphasizes that divorce is not just an event, but a complex and lengthy psychological process, different from the legal perspective, which considers it merely an end (Kaslow, F. W., 1980, 650:718). This study provides a clear framework for understanding the psychological journey of divorce, making understanding emotions essential.

For Divorced Women:

1. Emotional Divorce First: Kaslow points out that emotional divorce, which includes feelings such as anger, betrayal, and grief, often begins before the legal divorce. Understanding that these feelings are a normal part of the first stage allows a divorcee to deal with them more consciously rather than suppressing them. This awareness prevents her from passing on negative feelings to her children.

2. The Recovery Journey: By understanding the different stages (emotional, legal, economic), a divorcee can realize that recovery is not an immediate event, but rather a long-term process. This understanding helps her be more patient with herself and accept that feelings may change and resurface at each stage.

For Children:

1. Co-parenting: Research confirms the importance of the co-parenting stage of divorce. When a mother understands that this stage requires her to work with her father, even if her feelings toward him are negative, she is able to separate her personal differences from her role as a mother. This separation is essential to ensure the continuity of the relationship between the children and their father, providing them with a sense of security and stability.

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2. Naming Their Feelings: Children also go through different emotional stages during a divorce. A mother who understands the psychological stages of divorce is better able to help her children name their feelings (such as "I feel sad because I miss my dad" or "I'm angry because my life has changed"). This process is essential for building their psychological resilience because it teaches them that emotions, even negative ones, can be understood and processed.

3. Recovery as a Model: When children see their mother navigate the different stages of divorce and consciously process her emotions, she becomes a living model for them. She teaches them that crises can be managed and strength lies in facing emotions rather than running away from them.

The Importance of Understanding Emotions for Divorced Women and Children:

Sclater's study (1997, 423-441) approaches the topic of divorce from a different perspective, focusing on the narratives and stories individuals tell about their divorce experience, rather than focusing on statistical causes or outcomes. The study highlights how individuals construct their stories about what happened and how these narratives influence their understanding of themselves and their lives after divorce. The results demonstrate that divorce is not a single event, but rather a set of changing stories that evolve over time.

Linking the findings to the importance of understanding emotions for divorced women and children, this study provides a powerful framework for understanding why dealing with emotions is vital for divorced women and their children. Our stories about the past largely determine our present and future.

For Divorced Women:

1. Rewriting the Story: Divorced women may carry a story about divorce filled with bitterness, blame, and feelings of failure. This negative story can hinder their progress. Understanding the emotions that accompanied the divorce (anger, sadness, fear) helps her reframe her narrative. Instead of the "I am a victim" story, she can create a "I am a survivor" or "I am strong" story. This shift in narrative doesn't change the past, but it does shift her outlook on the future and empower her to move forward.

2. Feelings as part of the narrative: Feelings are not just reactions; they are an essential part of the story. When a divorced woman understands her feelings, she can integrate them into her story in a healthy way. Instead of repressing sadness or anger, she can integrate them as part of her journey toward growth and recovery.

For children:

1. Avoid passing on negative narratives: Children tend to internalize the narratives they hear from their parents. If a mother tells a bitter story about the

divorce, the child will learn and internalize this story, which may lead them to constantly blame themselves or one of their parents. This damages their psychological resilience because they associate their identity with a negative story about their family.

2. Building a shared positive narrative: By processing her own feelings, a mother can help her children build a healthier narrative about divorce. She can teach them that their family's story isn't over, it's just changed. She can focus on positive aspects, such as the continued love between their parents and the family's resilience, which fosters a sense of security and trust.

Sclater's study reminds us that divorce is a story to be told. Understanding emotions is key to changing this story from one of pain to one of growth. This change is essential for enabling the divorced mother to heal and setting a positive example for her children to build a healthy narrative about their lives, giving them the strength to face the future.

Understanding the complex emotions of divorced women is key to empowering them and their children to recover:

Understanding the complex emotions of divorced women is key to empowering them to recover and providing the necessary support to their children to help them overcome this experience with strength and resilience. Divorce is a psychological journey, not just a legal procedure.

A study (Thomas, C., & Ryan, M. 2008, pp. 210-224) examined women's perspectives on the divorce experience, using a qualitative approach to gain a deeper understanding of their feelings and personal experiences. Through interviews, the study revealed that divorce is not just a legal event, but a complex and lengthy process that causes women conflicting and changing feelings, such as feelings of liberation and failure at the same time. The results also indicated that women go through different stages of adjustment, from initial shock to self-reconstruction and the discovery of their new identity. This study emphasizes that understanding the emotions related to divorce is the foundation for recovery, not only for divorced women, but also for their children.

For divorcees:

Recovery begins with acknowledging feelings: The results show that a divorced woman may feel liberated from an unhealthy relationship, yet at the same time feel like a failure because she was unable to maintain her family. Understanding this contradiction is the first step toward recovery. When a woman acknowledges these feelings without judgment, she can process them in a healthy way, preventing them from negatively impacting her future life.

Rebuilding the Self: The divorce journey is an opportunity for self-recovery. Understanding the different emotions, from anger to acceptance, helps a divorced woman shed her old identity as a "wife" and build a new one as an

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independent and strong "person." This process is essential for her to stand on her own two feet again.

For children:

1. **Emotions as a compass:** Children monitor their parents' reactions. When a mother understands and works to process her feelings, she sets a healthy model for her children. Instead of repressing feelings of sadness or anger, she can teach them that it is normal to feel these emotions, and that what matters most is how to deal with them.
2. **Facilitating communication:** If a mother is aware of her own feelings, she will be better able to understand and discuss her children's feelings related to the divorce. She can create a safe space for them to express their fear, sadness, or even anger, without feeling like they're causing them distress. This open communication reduces the likelihood of developing psychological or behavioral problems in the future.
3. **Building psychological resilience:** By understanding and accepting her own and her children's feelings, the mother helps build psychological resilience in them. She teaches them that crises are a part of life and can be experienced and overcome with strength and resilience. This lesson gives them the tools to face their future anxieties with greater confidence.

The importance of psychological resilience and social support in dealing with life stress and reducing symptoms of depression:

- Imad Mukhaimer (Imad Muhammad Ahmad Mukhaimer, 1997, pp. 103-138) conducted a study to understand the role of psychological resilience and social support as factors that help university students cope with life stress and symptoms of depression. The study included 171 male and female students from Zagazig University, and they were administered tests to measure psychological resilience, social support, life stress, and depression. The results concluded that social support enhances and strengthens psychological resilience, and that both work together to help individuals cope with stress and maintain their mental health.
- The findings of Imad Mukhaimer's study can be directly applied to children living in divorced families. Parental separation is often one of the greatest psychological stressors a child may face, making them more vulnerable to anxiety about the future.

Here, psychological resilience and social support play a key role in helping these children.

1. **Psychological resilience:** This is the child's ability to adapt to the changes and difficulties imposed by divorce. The more psychologically resilient a child is, the greater their ability to cope with feelings of fear and anxiety about the unknown, and to understand that divorce does not mean the end of the world or a loss of security.
2. **Social support:** As the study demonstrated, social support enhances psychological resilience. This support can come from parents (even after separation), grandparents, relatives, friends, or even teachers. Having a strong support network makes a child feel loved and cared for, which reduces feelings of loneliness and boosts their self-confidence and ability to overcome challenges.

Therefore, it can be said that strengthening psychological resilience in children from divorced families is not limited to teaching them coping skills alone, but also requires providing a supportive and stable environment, which helps them face future anxiety with greater confidence.

Components of psychological resilience and their impact on reducing psychological distress:

244 high school students participated in a study that used scales to measure life events and psychological distress. The results showed an interaction between the components of psychological resilience itself, and that gender influences psychological resilience, with overall results favoring females. The role of psychological resilience in children from divorced families is profound.

A study by David Chan provides important insights that can be applied to children living in divorced families. Divorce is a stressful life event that can cause significant psychological distress for children, increasing their anxiety about the future. David, W., 2000, 190, 191, 197-161)), and the study emphasizes the importance of strengthening psychological resilience in children in divorced families, and this requires parents to understand the components of this resilience and work to strengthen it: Psychological resilience consists of several intertwined elements in the context of divorce.

These components may include control (the child's feeling that he has some control over his life despite the changes), commitment (finding meaning and purpose in his life, such as focusing on his studies or hobbies), and challenge (considering divorce as an experience from which one can learn and grow).

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Regarding the gender factor, the result indicated that females may be more psychologically resilient, which could be an important point for parents and specialists. While girls may demonstrate a greater ability to express their feelings and seek support, boys may need more help expressing their feelings and developing coping strategies. Therefore, parents should pay attention to individual differences among their children and provide appropriate support for each child, regardless of gender.

Therefore, fostering resilience in children of divorced families requires parents to understand the components of resilience and work to strengthen them, keeping in mind that boys' needs may differ from those of girls. This comprehensive understanding helps children better cope with future anxiety and recover from the effects of divorce.

Factors that enhance psychological resilience in divorced families:

The study by (Greeff, A. P., & Van Der Merwe, S., 2004, 59-75) aimed to identify the variables associated with resilience in divorced families. The research focused on analyzing the factors that help family members, particularly children, adapt positively to the challenges imposed by parental separation. The most prominent variables identified were **social support, effective coping mechanisms, and good family communication** even after the divorce. The findings confirmed that having a strong support network (from family, friends, or professionals) plays a crucial role in mitigating the negative effects of divorce on children. Furthermore, the ability of individuals to use positive coping strategies, such as focusing on solutions rather than problems, enhances their psychological resilience.

Thesis Relevance to the Importance of Psychological Resilience for Children After Divorce This thesis is directly related to your research on the importance of psychological resilience for children after divorce in several aspect, Confirming the Importance: The study provides strong scientific evidence confirming that psychological resilience is not merely a theoretical concept, but rather a set of measurable and quantifiable variables. This reinforces your research hypothesis that psychological resilience is key to children's adjustment after divorce., Identifying Variables: The study helps identify key variables that you can focus on in your research, such as social support, coping

mechanisms, and communication. These variables can be considered sub-dimensions of psychological resilience, helping you develop accurate measurement tools., Building an Interventional Framework: The study's findings provide practical insights into how to support children. For example, its findings can be used to justify the need to design intervention programs that focus on strengthening children's social support networks and training them in positive coping strategies.

Overall, the study by Greeff and Van Der Merwe (2004) is a fundamental reference that enriches the theoretical framework of your research and emphasizes the importance of environmental and personal factors in enhancing children's resilience during divorce.

Psychological Resilience and Identity Crisis:

The study (Muhammad Izzat Arabi Katbi, 2015) aimed to explore the relationship between resilience and identity crisis among a sample of Damascus University students, in addition to determining whether there were differences in their scores based on gender and academic level. A total of 255 male and female students (144 males and 111 females) participated in the study. The researcher used the descriptive analytical approach to test the research hypotheses, the most prominent of which were: There is no relationship between psychological resilience and identity crisis, and no differences between genders or educational levels on either scale.

The results were as follows:

There was no statistical relationship between psychological resilience and identity crisis. There was no difference between males and females in the level of psychological resilience. There was a difference in the level of psychological resilience according to the educational level. There was a difference in the identity crisis according to gender (males and females). Although this study focused on university students, its results can provide important insights into the psychological resilience of children in divorced families, and into psychological resilience and identity crisis.

Divorce represents a major event that can impact a child's identity, as they may begin to question their place in the new family and lose a sense of stability, which generates anxiety about the future. The study indicated no direct relationship between psychological resilience and identity crisis. This

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may mean psychological resilience does not necessarily prevent the emergence of an identity crisis after a traumatic event such as divorce, but it may be a crucial tool for dealing with and recovering from that crisis. A resilient child may experience an identity crisis, but they will be better equipped to rebuild their sense of self and identity.

The results showed differences in the identity crisis between males and females. This is consistent with a number of studies indicating that males and females may experience divorce differently. Males may have greater difficulty expressing their emotions, which may lead to a different manifestation of the identity crisis than females. This underscores the importance of understanding individual differences and providing appropriate support for each child according to their needs.

Regarding the relationship between psychological resilience and academic level, the difference in psychological resilience according to academic level may indicate that psychological resilience is a skill that develops over time and experience. As a child grows older and faces new challenges, their psychological resilience may increase. This gives parents hope that their children, even if they experience divorce at an early age, will acquire more tools to cope with anxiety and future challenges over time. The study highlights that psychological resilience is not a magic bullet that prevents crises, but rather a set of skills that help children overcome challenges, including the future anxiety imposed by divorce. In 2002, Fadl Ibrahim (Fadl Ibrahim Abdel Samad, 2002, pp. 284-299) conducted a study aimed at examining the relationship between psychological resilience, religious awareness, and meaning in life.

The study also sought to understand the psychological characteristics of more and less psychologically resilient individuals using a clinical approach. The sample included 248 graduate students, ranging in age from 24 to 28 years. The study used scales to measure psychological resilience, religious awareness, and meaning in life. The results showed a strong, positive relationship between psychological resilience and both deep (intrinsic) religious awareness and a sense of meaning in life. The results also indicated that there were no significant differences between more and less psychologically resilient individuals with regard to superficial (apparent) religious awareness.

The results of this study provide a valuable framework that can be used to understand and support children facing future anxiety due to their

parents' divorce. Divorce is an event that can shake a child's sense of security and stability, causing them to question the meaning of life and their personal worth. The study also confirms the positive relationship between psychological resilience and meaning in life.

For a child in a family for a divorced child, their sense of meaning in life may come from various sources, such as:

1. **Family relationships:** Maintaining a strong relationship with both parents, grandparents, and relatives.
2. **Hobbies and interests:** Engaging in activities they enjoy (such as sports, art, or music).
3. **Academic achievement:** Success in school can give a child a sense of purpose and competence.

When a child finds meaning in their life, they are better able to face future anxiety and the challenges posed by divorce. Psychological resilience is also related to a deep (intrinsic) religious awareness. Faith can be a major source of inner strength. Teaching a child religious values in a deep, rather than superficial, way can give them a sense of comfort and hope. Faith can provide a child with a strong framework for understanding difficulties as part of life and help them feel optimistic and believe that things will get better.

Parents and educators can benefit from these findings by focusing on the following points:

1. Encouraging children to build healthy and stable relationships.
2. Helping them discover their passions and hobbies.
3. Providing a positive learning environment.
4. Developing their religious awareness in a deep, focused way. Spiritual values.

Ultimately, this study confirms that psychological resilience is not merely a personality trait, but rather a psychological construct that can be enhanced through external sources such as social support and the family environment, and internal sources such as faith and a sense of purpose.

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The study, conducted by Nabil Kamel Dokhan and Bashir Ibrahim Al-Hajjar (2006), analyzed the relationship between psychological stress and psychological resilience among Islamic University students. The sample included 541 male and female students, and the researchers used special scales to measure both variables. The results showed that male students suffer from higher levels of psychological stress than female students.

The researchers also found a negative relationship between psychological stress and psychological resilience, meaning that the higher the psychological resilience, the lower the level of psychological stress. Although this study focused on university students, its results are subjective.

Similarities and Differences in Emotional Divorce and its Impact on Children:

Damo and Cenci's study focused on the concept of emotional divorce, which is the state of psychological and emotional separation between spouses despite the continuation of the marital relationship. The study analyzed the similarities and differences in this emotional experience based on each individual's position (husband, wife). The results found that wives are often more aware of emotional divorce than their husbands, and exhibit strong negative emotions such as sadness, loneliness, and anger. In contrast, husbands tend to ignore or downplay these feelings. This study highlights a fundamental point: emotional separation often occurs years before legal separation. Understanding this dynamic is crucial for both mothers and children.

(Damo, D. D., & Cenci, C. M. B., 2021, p. 505-518)

For the divorced woman:

The mother's awareness of her feelings of sadness, anger, or frustration is not just an overreaction; rather, it is a natural consequence of the emotional divorce she may have experienced for years. This understanding helps her accept these feelings and deal with them in a healthy way, rather than suppressing them or feeling guilty about them.

Psychological recovery: The recovery process begins with acknowledging the existence of the problem. When the divorced woman understands that the separation was a long and complicated process, she can begin the journey

of healing from the emotional wounds that preceded the official divorce. This paves the way for her to build a new life free from the pain of the past.

For the children:

Emotional divorce is often silent and invisible, but it creates tension and repression in the home. Children are very sensitive to this atmosphere and may interpret the silence and coldness between the parents as their fault. A mother's understanding of her feelings helps her be more aware of the impact this conflict has on her children. When the divorced woman understands her feelings, she can better communicate with her children about what they are going through. She can reassure them that their feelings of sadness or anxiety are normal, and that they are not responsible for what happened. This open dialogue gives children a safe space to express their feelings, reducing the likelihood of developing psychological problems later. A mother's understanding of her feelings and working toward recovery sets a positive example for her children: She teaches them that feelings must be lived and processed, and that true strength lies in facing emotional difficulties rather than ignoring them. This lesson builds children's psychological resilience to face future challenges. Understanding emotional divorce and its impact on emotions is an essential step toward psychological recovery for the divorced mother and her children, helping to build a supportive environment that enables them to overcome difficulties and begin a new, more stable life.

Divorce is a profound identity crisis:

This study summarizes the systematic review conducted by a team of researchers (Harris, S. M., Fenske, S. R., Baer, S., Dick, M., Katovich, J., Osterbauer, M., & Roberts, K. R., 2022, pp. 464-481) that focuses on the impact of identity on the decision to divorce. Using grounded theory, the research indicates that the decision to separate is not merely a rational one, but rather a complex process greatly influenced by the internal conflict between one's personal identity and their identity as a "husband" or "wife." When a person's true identity conflicts with the role they play in the marriage, this can lead to an internal crisis that pushes them toward divorce.

The Importance of Understanding Emotions for Divorced Women and Children:

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This study emphasizes that divorce is a profound identity crisis, making understanding the emotions associated with this crisis essential for both the divorced woman and her children.

For the divorced woman:

1. **Understanding the internal conflict:** A divorced woman may not realize that her feelings of sadness, anger, or even liberation are related to the conflict between her personal identity and her role as a wife. Understanding that the divorce was the result of a deep identity conflict helps her be more compassionate with herself and realize that her feelings are not just a reaction to failure, but rather part of the process of self-rediscovery.
2. **The journey of rebuilding identity:** When a divorced woman understands that divorce is an opportunity to rebuild her identity, she can channel her emotions in a healthy way. Instead of focusing on what she has lost (her identity as a wife), she can focus on what she will gain (a strong, independent identity). This shift in understanding helps her overcome negative feelings more quickly.

For the children:

1. **The impact of the crisis on the child's identity:** Children connect their identity to the family. When a family dissolves, they too face an identity crisis. They may feel like they are part of two families, or that their identity as children of a married couple has ended. A mother's understanding of her own experience helps her empathize with her children's feelings related to their changing identity.
2. **Providing a positive role model:** When a divorced woman deals with her feelings and works to rebuild her identity in a healthy way, she sets a strong role model for her children. She teaches them that challenges can be opportunities for growth, and that it's normal for identity to change and evolve. This lesson builds children's resilience and helps them face future anxiety with greater confidence.

This study offers a new perspective on divorce as an identity crisis. Understanding the divorced woman's feelings related to this conflict is key to enabling her to recover and providing a healthy role model for her children, helping them rebuild their identity with confidence after the crisis.

Loss of financial security, loss of social role, and loss of a sense of complete family.

This study by Charles Huber (Huber, C. H., 1983, 357-361) examines the feelings associated with loss that individuals experience after divorce. The research provides a model for assessing these feelings and for therapeutic interventions to address them. Huber explains that divorce is not simply the end of a relationship, but rather a series of emotional losses, such as the loss of marital identity, loss of financial security, loss of social role, and loss of a sense of complete family. This study emphasizes that understanding the feelings related to divorce is the foundation of recovery, as these feelings are not simply a reaction to the separation, but rather a response to the multiple losses imposed by divorce.

For the divorced woman:

1. **Naming the losses:** A divorced woman may feel sad or depressed without realizing the true cause. This research demonstrates that these feelings are linked to specific losses. When a divorced woman understands that she is grieving not only for her husband, but also for the loss of her "position" as a wife, the loss of security, and the loss of the lifestyle she was accustomed to, she can address each loss individually.
2. **Healing begins with acceptance:** When a divorced mother accepts that sadness and anger are a normal part of the loss process, she can begin the healing journey. This understanding prevents her from feeling guilty about her feelings and helps her process them healthily.

For children:

Understanding their own losses: Children also face losses after divorce, such as the loss of their daily routine with both parents and the loss of the "family form" they knew. When a divorced mother understands that her child's sadness or anger isn't necessarily about her or their parent, but rather about the loss of something dear to them, she can be more empathetic.

1. **Open communication:** A mother who understands the concept of loss can talk openly and transparently with her children about what they're going through. She can say, "I know you're feeling sad that we're no longer living together, and that's a normal feeling." This open dialogue gives the child a safe space to express their feelings, which builds resilience and reduces anxiety about the future.

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2. **Recovery Model:** When children see their mother deal with her emotions and work through her losses, she becomes a living model of strength and resilience. She teaches them that negative feelings can be processed, losses can be overcome, and life can continue positively. Hopper's research demonstrates that divorce is a multifaceted loss experience. Understanding these losses and their feelings is key to a divorced mother's recovery and providing the necessary support to help her children overcome their losses and build a new life with resilience and confidence.

The Impact of Psychological Resilience on Psychological Responses to Stress:

The study conducted by Morikata Kosaka (1996) aimed to explore the impact of psychological resilience on psychological responses to stress.

The sample included 244 university students. The PSRs were used to measure their responses to stress, in addition to analyzing the three factors of psychological resilience.

The results showed a moderate to strong correlation between the dimensions of psychological resilience. Although this study focused on university students, its findings hold important implications for children of divorced families and their ability to cope with future anxiety.

Divorce is a highly stressful event for children and can trigger feelings of uncertainty and anxiety about their future. Here comes the role of psychological resilience as a crucial factor. Psychological resilience is not simply the ability to withstand difficulties; it is a set of qualities that enable individuals to transform stress into opportunities for growth and learning.

The three interrelated dimensions of psychological resilience are:

1. **Commitment:** A sense of engagement in life and work, and finding meaning and purpose in what they do. For a child in a divorced family, commitment can help them maintain their interests and hobbies, providing a sense of stability amidst change.
2. **Control:** The belief that they have the ability to influence events in their life, rather than feeling powerless. This dimension gives the child a sense of personal power, helping them adapt to circumstances they cannot fully control.
3. **Challenge:** The tendency to view changes and stresses as opportunities for growth rather than threats. This positive outlook enables the child to approach conflicts or changes brought about by divorce as an opportunity to learn resilience and problem-solving.

Therefore, by fostering these dimensions in children, parents can provide them with the tools to cope with future anxiety. The study indicates that psychological resilience directly affects how an individual responds to stress, underscoring its importance in helping children of divorced families overcome the emotional and psychological challenges associated with divorce and build a confident and stable future.

The Relationship Between Social Anxiety and Psychological Resilience:

The study by Mona Akoub and Sabah Al-Saqa (2017) aimed to examine the relationship between social anxiety and psychological resilience among high school students in Damascus, as well as to determine whether there were differences in these two variables based on gender or grade level.

The sample included 698 randomly selected male and female students. The study used the Social Anxiety Scale and the Psychological Resilience Scale to collect data. This study indicates a relationship between psychological resilience and the ability to cope with social anxiety in adolescents. This concept can be directly linked to the topic of divorced families. Children in divorced families often face unique challenges that may cause them anxiety about the future, such as fear of instability, interparental conflict, or feelings of guilt. In these cases, psychological resilience plays a vital role. It is not simply the ability to "resilience" or "endurance," but rather a set of qualities that help an individual adapt to challenges and stressors and transform them into opportunities for growth. For children of divorced families, psychological resilience enhances their ability to:

1. Cope with change and adapt to changes in living routines or moving between two homes without feeling lost.
2. Build resilience: Learn how to recover from emotional trauma or disappointment.
3. Sense of control: Realizing they have the power to influence their lives, even in difficult circumstances beyond their control.
4. Realistic optimism: Maintaining a positive outlook on the future, recognizing that challenges are a normal part of life.

Psychological resilience can act as a buffer against the negative effects of anxiety associated with divorce. By cultivating this resilience, parents can provide their children with essential tools to confidently face their future, regardless of the family structure.

Divorce is a major source of anxiety and uncertainty for children.

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The study (Mahdi Anad Al-Awad and Ali Nahili, 2014) aimed to understand the relationship between psychological resilience and future anxiety. The study included 622 male and female students from Damascus University.

Two scales were used to measure psychological resilience and future anxiety. The results revealed an inverse correlation between the two variables, meaning that the higher the psychological resilience of the student, the less anxiety they felt about the future. The results also revealed gender differences, with males showing higher levels of psychological resilience, while females showed higher levels of future anxiety.

The results of this study are particularly relevant in the context of children living in divorced families. Divorce is often a major source of anxiety and uncertainty for children, especially regarding their future. Changes in family structure, financial problems, and conflicts between parents can cause children to feel threatened and fearful. In this context, psychological resilience acts as a protective shield to protect the child from the negative effects of these pressures.

A child with psychological resilience can face these challenges in a constructive manner. They don't see divorce as a catastrophe, but rather as a part of life that can be adapted to. They can use their internal skills to manage their emotions and commit to their new life, rather than withdrawing or giving in to anxiety. A child's ability to view challenges as opportunities for growth is the foundation of psychological resilience, which helps them overcome difficulties.

Therefore, it is essential for parents and professionals to focus on promoting psychological resilience in children affected by divorce. This can be achieved by:

1. **Providing a stable environment:** Maintaining daily routines as much as possible and avoiding conflicts in front of the child.
2. **Encouraging emotional expression:** Allowing the child to talk about their fears and anxieties without judgment.
3. **Building self-confidence:** Praising the child's efforts and encouraging them to achieve goals.

Through these practices, adults can help children build the psychological resilience needed not only to cope with future anxiety caused by divorce, but also to be better prepared to face future life challenges with confidence and strength.

Psychological resilience plays a crucial role in helping these children adapt. A study conducted by (Hisham Ali Al-Qutb Muhammad Al-Faqi, Reda Rizk Ibrahim Habib, Fathi Al-Sayed Mahrez Lotfy. 2021, 450, 451) aimed to explore the relationship between psychological resilience and future anxiety among a sample of Al-Azhar University students. The study included 228 students from the Faculty of Education, with an average age of approximately 20 years.

The researchers used two scales:

one to measure psychological resilience and the other to measure future anxiety. The results showed a strong negative correlation between the two variables, indicating that students with higher psychological resilience tend to feel less anxiety about the future. The results also showed no statistically significant differences in psychological resilience or future anxiety based on academic specialization (scientific or literary).

The results of this study can be used as a framework for understanding how psychological resilience affects children in divorced families, particularly in the face of future anxiety. The study suggests that psychological resilience acts as a protective factor against anxiety, and this is especially true for children facing significant challenges such as parental divorce.

For children in divorced families, anxiety about the future can be particularly intense. They may feel uncertain about who they will live with, how their social and school lives will change, and whether a parent will leave their lives. In this context, psychological resilience plays a crucial role in helping these children adapt.

If a child has high psychological resilience, they often have the ability to:

1. **Control:** Feeling like they have some control over their life, even in the midst of significant change.
2. **Commitment:** Staying committed to their relationships with parents, friends, and school activities.
3. **Challenge:** Seeing divorce as an obstacle to overcome, rather than the end of normal life.

Therefore, parents and professionals should focus on fostering these characteristics in children in divorced families. This can be achieved by providing a supportive and stable environment, maintaining open and honest communication, and helping the child develop positive coping skills. By building psychological resilience, children can not only cope

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with the future anxiety caused by divorce, but also emerge stronger and more prepared for future challenges.

The feeling that the hopes of a happy marriage and family stability have been shattered, and that their future, including caring for their children and meeting their needs, has made divorced women more vulnerable to depression and anxiety. Some divorced women, especially those who are unemployed and less educated, suffer from diminished social support, even though for some women, divorce is a convenient solution to a violent marital relationship. Divorced women should seek support from their families to support their children, avoid psychological illness, overcome family disintegration, and deal with the pressures resulting from divorce, such as financial pressures and the need to satisfy emotional needs. This impacts children's well-being and their ability to overcome crises, difficult circumstances, and life's psychological pressures.

Commentary on the Theoretical Framework and Previous Studies

The theoretical framework and previous studies are closely linked to the title of the research, Analysis of the Dimensions of Psychological Resilience in Children and Their Perceptions of the Divorce Crisis: A Descriptive and Analytical Study. This review represents the theoretical foundation upon which the research is based. The theoretical framework and previous studies provide a broad epistemological foundation for understanding the relationship between psychological resilience and the divorce crisis. These findings highlight that resilience is not merely an individual trait, but rather a social and psychological process influenced by the surrounding environment. The support provided by family, friends, and teachers gives children a sense of security and acceptance, which serves as a protective shield against the negative effects of divorce. Acquiring healthy coping mechanisms, such as expressing emotions or engaging in meaningful activities, enables children to transform the divorce experience from a source of anxiety into an opportunity for growth and learning. The New Insights Offered by the Current Research: Despite the rich literature in this field, most of the studies reviewed focus on Western cultural contexts or examine the relationship in general. This research offers a new insight through:

1 .**Focusing on the cultural context:** The research will examine how sociocultural characteristics influence children's psychological resilience in a context different from Western environments, potentially revealing unique coping mechanisms and social support.

2 .Descriptive and Analytical Methodology: The research will provide an in-depth analysis of the various dimensions of psychological resilience in children and analyze their direct correlation with their perceptions of the divorce crisis, providing quantitative and qualitative data that contribute to a deeper understanding of this relationship.

3 .Identifying the Dimensions of Psychological Resilience: The research will contribute to identifying the specific dimensions of psychological resilience in children affected by divorce, enabling the design of more effective intervention programs that specifically target these dimensions.

Thus, the research does not merely confirm what is known, but rather seeks to add new and specialized knowledge that serves to understand and meet the needs of children affected by divorce more accurately and comprehensively. Below is a sample psychological scale for children's psychological resilience, divided into axes, its scoring method, and final score. The psychometric properties of this scale are being verified and presented in independent research.

1. First: The Psychological Resilience Scale for Children.

This scale is designed to assess a child's ability to adapt positively to difficult circumstances, such as a divorce crisis, by measuring several dimensions.

Scale Axes: The scale consists of three main axes, each with a set of items:

Axis One: Self-Efficacy

This axis measures the child's belief in his or her ability to cope with various challenges and tasks.

	Self-Efficacy	Never	Rarely	Sometimes	Often	Always
1	I can solve my problems on my own.					
2	I am confident in my ability to succeed in school.					
3	I know how to deal with my negative feelings.					
4	I can learn new things easily.					
5	I can adapt to changes in my life.					

Axis II: Social Relationships

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This axis measures a child's ability to build and maintain supportive relationships with others.

	Social Relationships	Never	Rarely	Sometimes	Often	Always
1	I can ask for help from adults when I need it (such as a teacher or relatives).					
2	I feel loved by my family.					
3	I feel I have good friends.					
4	I can express my opinions clearly in front of others.					
5	I feel comfortable spending time with others.					

Axis 3: Emotional Flexibility

This axis measures a child's ability to control their emotions and recover from negative emotions.

	Emotional Flexibility	Never	Rarely	Sometimes	Often	Always
1	When I feel sad, I can do something to cheer me up.					
2	I don't stay angry for long.					
3	When I feel afraid, I can calm down.					
4	I know what emotions I'm feeling (such as anger, sadness, joy).					
5	I can get through difficult experiences.					

Scoring Method: A Likert scale is used for scoring, with the child choosing the answer that best represents them: Always: 5 points, often: 4 points, , Sometimes: 3 points, Rarely: 2 points, Never: 1 point

Final Score: The final score for the scale is calculated by adding the child's scores on all 15 items. Maximum score: 15 (items) x 5 (points) = 75 points.

• Minimum score: 15 (items) x 1 (point) = 15 points., Score Interpretation:

- High score (close to 75): Indicates that the child has a high degree of psychological resilience.
- Medium score (around 45): Indicates that the child has an average level of psychological resilience and may need additional support in some areas.
- Low score (close to 15): Indicates that the child is facing significant difficulties in coping and needs specialized psychological support and assistance. Below is a sample of the Child's Perception of Divorce Crisis Scale, divided into axes, its scoring method, and final score. The psychometric properties of this scale are being verified and presented in an independent study.

Second: The Child's Perception of Divorce Crisis Scale. The Child's Perception of Divorce Crisis Scale: This scale is designed to assess the perceived negative effects of the divorce crisis on the child, by measuring several dimensions.

Scale Axes: The scale consists of three main axes, each with a set of items:

Axis One: Negative Emotions

This axis measures the feelings of sadness, fear, anger, and confusion experienced by the child as a result of the divorce.

	Negative Emotions	Never	Rarely	Sometimes	Often	Always
1	I feel sad when I remember that my parents are no longer living together.					
2	I'm afraid of the future and don't know what will happen to me.					
3	I feel angry toward one or both of my parents.					
4	I sometimes blame myself for what happened.					
5	I feel lonely even when I'm with my friends.					

Axis II: Behavioral and Social Changes

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This axis measures changes in the child's behavior, such as academic decline or withdrawal from social activities.

	Behavioral and Social Changes	Never	Rarely	Sometimes	Often	Always
1	I no longer enjoy going to school as much as I used to.					
2	I no longer enjoy playing with my friends as much as I used to.					
3	I feel like I don't want to talk to anyone.					
4	I find it difficult to concentrate on my studies.					
5	I have more problems with my siblings and friends than before.					

Axis 3: Parental Conflict Perception

This axis measures the child's perception of and response to conflict between parents.

	Parental Conflict Perception	Never	Rarely	Sometimes	Often	Always
1	I hear my parents arguing a lot.					
2	One of my parents sometimes asks me to choose between them and the other.					
3	I feel compelled to break the news between my parents.					
4	I hide my feelings from my parents so as not to upset them.					
5	I feel nervous when I talk to one parent about the other.					

Coring Method: A Likert scale is used for scoring, with the child choosing the answer that best describes them:

- Always applies to me: 5 points

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- Often applies to me: 4 points
- Sometimes applies to me: 3 points
- Rarely applies to me: 2 points
- Never applies to me: 1 point

Final Score:

- The final score for the scale is calculated by adding the child's scores on all 15 items.
- Maximum score: 15 (item) x 5 (points) = 75 points.
- Minimum score: 15 (item) x 1 (point) = 15 points.

Score Interpretation:

- High score (close to 75): Indicates that the child is highly aware of the crisis and is experiencing strong negative effects.
- Medium score (around 45): Indicates that the child is aware of the crisis but is coping with it at an acceptable level of adaptation.
- Low score (close to 15): Indicates that the child is not highly aware of the crisis or that its negative effects are limited.

Results and Interpretation:

1) Question 1: What are the dimensions of the Children's Psychological Resilience Scale, and which items measure each dimension?

A scientific model was developed to construct a Children's Psychological Resilience Scale, consisting of three axes, as follows:

1. Axis 1: Self-Efficacy

2. Axis 2: Social Relationships

3. Axis 3: Emotional Flexibility

This question aims to explore the factor structure of the scale, i.e., identify the main axes (such as self-efficacy, social relationships, emotional flexibility), and then identify the items that follow each axis.

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2) Question 2: What are the dimensions through which children perceive the divorce crisis, and what are the behavioral and emotional indicators for each dimension?

A scientific model was developed to construct a scale for children's perception of the divorce crisis. It consists of three axes, as follows:

1. Axis One: Negative Emotions

2. Axis Two: Behavioral and Social Changes

3. Axis Three: Parental Conflict Perception

This question seeks to reveal how children perceive the concept of the divorce crisis from their perspective, and to identify its main dimensions as perceived by children (such as negative emotions, behavioral and social changes, parental conflict), and the items that reflect each dimension.

Based on the axes and items presented for the scale, we can identify the behavioral and emotional indicators for each dimension as follows:

Behavioral Indicators

The behavioral indicators are directly evident in the second axis of the scale, "Behavioral and Social Changes." These indicators are the actions and behaviors that the child performs or ceases to perform as a result of being affected by the divorce.

- 1) **Academic decline:** Not wanting to go to school or having difficulty concentrating on lessons, as described in paragraphs 1 and 4 of Axis II.
- 2) **Social withdrawal:** Not enjoying playing with friends or wanting to isolate oneself and not talk to anyone, as described in paragraphs 2 and 3 of Axis II.
- 3) **Aggression or behavioral problems:** Increased problems or conflicts with siblings and friends, as described in paragraph 5 of Axis II.

▪ **Emotional indicators:**

The emotional indicators are represented in Axis I, "Negative Feelings." These indicators are the internal states and feelings experienced by the child, which may not be apparent to everyone.

1. **Sadness and loneliness:** Feeling sad when remembering the parents' separation and feeling lonely even in the presence of others, as described in paragraphs 1 and 5 of Axis I.
2. **Fear and anxiety:** Fear of the future or the unknown that awaits the child, as described in paragraph 2 of Axis I.
 - 1) **Anger:** Feeling angry toward one or both parents, as described in paragraph 3 of Axis I.
 - 2) **Guilt:** The child blames himself for what happened between his parents, as shown in paragraph 4 of Axis 1. There are also emotional indicators in Axis 3, "Parental Conflict," which relate to the stress and anxiety resulting from conflict between the parents.
 - 3) **Stress and Anxiety:** Feeling tense when discussing a parent with the other, or hiding feelings to avoid upsetting them, as shown in paragraphs 4 and 5 of Axis 3.

Recommendations and Future Studies:

▪ **Recommendations:**

1. Develop therapeutic programs based on a positive psychology perspective and implement them in schools to enhance psychological resilience among children who have experienced divorce. This should focus on developing positive concepts that have been strongly associated with increased psychological resilience, such as problem-solving skills and emotional control to prevent potential mental illness caused by the accumulation of negative emotions.
2. Organize workshops for separated parents to teach them how to manage conflicts and exchange kindness and respect to mitigate the effects of the divorce crisis on their children.
3. Provide "indirect" psychological support in schools for children suffering from the effects of divorce, focusing on strengthening their social relationships with their classmates and teachers.

Practical recommendations for parents of broken families to develop the psychological resilience of emotionally affected children and protect them from mental illness. The key to psychological resilience lies in helping the child understand their feelings, providing a stable and supportive environment, and teaching them that crises can be overcome with strength and resilience. Therefore, parents should:

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1. Encourage the child to express their feelings (sadness, anger, fear) in simple words, as this teaches the child that their feelings are acceptable and not wrong.
 2. Do not speak badly about the other party in front of the child, and do not make them feel they must choose a side. This reduces their internal conflict and protects them from feelings of divided loyalty.
 3. Maintain a consistent daily routine as much as possible (mealtimes, bedtimes, homework). Routine gives the child a sense of security and continuity in the face of major changes.
 4. Try to maintain as much stability as possible in their life, such as staying in the same school, interacting with the same friends, or practicing the same hobbies. This helps reduce their sense of loss of control.
 5. Encourage your child to pursue hobbies and interests. When they succeed at something they love, it boosts their self-confidence and gives them a sense of purpose.
 6. Help your child develop problem-solving skills. Instead of solving their problems themselves, help them think of solutions. Ask them, "What can we do about this?" This teaches them that they have the power to face challenges.
 7. Provide a positive model of recovery where they can take care of themselves. When your child sees you taking care of your mental health and seeking help when needed, you are setting a strong example. It's a message that strength lies in facing problems, not in ignoring them.
 8. Don't make your child responsible for your happiness or sadness. Give them space to be a child, without feeling the burden of taking care of you.
 9. Build social support networks through family relationships and spending time with grandparents, relatives, and friends. These relationships provide them with additional sources of love and security. □ Do not hesitate to seek help from a psychological counselor specializing in this field, or from psychiatrists specializing in family therapy or child psychiatry if you notice that your child is having difficulty adjusting psychologically after separation.
- **Suggested future studies:**
1. The impact of the "Building Social Support Networks" program on children's psychological resilience after divorce.
 2. Conduct longitudinal follow-up studies to assess the development of children's psychological resilience over long periods after divorce.

3. Conduct comparative studies to compare the levels of psychological resilience between children who have experienced divorce and their peers from stable families, to identify subtle differences in their ability to cope with life crises.
4. Examine the role of other variables, such as perceived familial support for the mother and children, the mother's ability to achieve financial independence, age at the time of divorce, and emotional needs satisfaction, in influencing the relationship between psychological resilience and perception of the divorce crisis.
5. The effect of a therapeutic program to develop psychological resilience and reduce future anxiety among children in divorced families.
6. The effectiveness of a self-compassion training program in enhancing psychological resilience in children after parental separation.
7. The impact of a parental mediation program on children's psychological resilience by reducing interparental conflict.
8. A social problem-solving skills training program: Its impact on psychological resilience in children in divorced families.
9. Evaluation of the effectiveness of play therapy in developing psychological resilience in children in divorced families.
10. The impact of a positive storytelling program on the psychological resilience of children in divorced families.
11. The effectiveness of the "Teacher as Mentor" program in enhancing psychological resilience in children affected by divorce.
12. The impact of a "Parent Training" program on the psychological resilience skills of their children after separation.
13. A counseling program to increase self-awareness of emotions: Its impact on the psychological resilience of adolescents in divorced families.
14. The Impact of Pre-Divorce Violence on Children's Long-Term Resilience in Arab Contexts.
15. Maternal Psychological Illness and Its Effect on Children's Resilience Post-Divorce.
16. The Role of Extended Family Social Support in Mediating Divorce Stress: A comparative study in an Arab context.

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17. A Longitudinal Study on the Evolution of Children's Perception of Divorce at Different Developmental Stages.
18. The Influence of Post-Divorce Economic Crises on Maternal Resilience and Its Reflection on Children's Well-being.
19. The Development of a Culturally-Sensitive Diagnostic Tool for Identifying Vulnerable Children: A psychometric study.
20. The Effectiveness of Positive Psychology-Based Interventions in Enhancing Children's Resilience.
21. The Role of Paternal Involvement in Enhancing Children's Resilience in Post-Divorce Families in the Middle East.
22. An Investigation into the Connection between Physical Illness in Mothers and Children's Psychological Resilience
23. A Psycho-Educational Program for Parents to Enhance Children's Resilience Post-Divorce.

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تحليل أبعاد المرونة النفسية لدى الأطفال وإدراكهم لأزمة الطلاق: دراسة وصفية تحليلية

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أستاذ بجامعة عين شمس "بياتو"، دكتوراه علم النفس التربوي "علم النفس الإيجابي"، دكتوراه الصحة النفسية "العلاج النفسي التكاملية"

ملخص :

تستهدف هذه الدراسة تحليل أبعاد المرونة النفسية لدى الأطفال وإدراكهم لأزمة الطلاق، وذلك ضمن إطار المنهج الوصفي التحليلي، وسعى البحث إلى تحقيق هدفين رئيسيين: أولاً، تحديد المكونات الجوهرية لمفهوم المرونة النفسية من وجهة نظر الأطفال، وثانياً، الكشف عن الأبعاد التي يدرك من خلالها الأطفال أزمة الطلاق ومؤشرات السلوكية والانفعالية، ولتحقيق هذه الأهداف، تم الاعتماد على مراجعة نقدية للإطار النظري والدراسات السابقة، والإجابة على التساؤلين البحثيين الأساسيين، وقد خلصت الدراسة إلى بناء نموذج نظري متعدد الأبعاد لمقياس المرونة النفسية لدى الأطفال، يتكون من:

الكفاءة الذاتية وتشير إلى القدرة على التعامل مع التحديات، العلاقات الاجتماعية وتتمثل في جودة الدعم المقدم من المحيطين، المرونة العاطفية وتعكس قدرة الطفل على إدارة وتقبل مشاعره، كما توصلت الدراسة إلى نموذج إدراكي لأزمة الطلاق يتضمن أبعاداً ترتبط بمؤشرات سلوكية (مثل التراجع الأكاديمي والعنصرية) ومؤشرات انفعالية (مثل الحزن والقلق)، وبناءً على هذه النتائج، يوصي البحث بضرورة تطوير برامج علاجية ووقائية قائمة على أسس علم النفس الإيجابي لتعزيز المرونة النفسية، وتقديم إرشادات عملية للوالدين، واقتراح أبحاث مستقبلية لاستكمال المعرفة في هذا المجال.

الرؤية الجديدة للبحث: على الرغم من ثراء الأدبيات الغربية في مجال المرونة النفسية وتأثير الطلاق، ويقدم هذا البحث رؤية جديدة ومساهمة علمية متميزة تتمثل في:

١. تأصيل السياق الثقافي يتناول البحث أثر الخصائص الاجتماعية والثقافية على المرونة النفسية في سياق مغاير للبيئات الغربية، مما يساهم في الكشف عن آليات تكيف ودعم قد تكون فريدة.
 ٢. المنهجية المبتكرة يعتمد البحث على منهجية وصفية تحليلية لتقديم تحليل معمق لأبعاد المرونة النفسية وعلاقتها المباشرة بإدراك الأطفال لأزمة الطلاق، مما يوفر بيانات نوعية وكمية دقيقة.
 ٣. تحديد الأبعاد يساهم البحث في تحديد الأبعاد المحددة للمرونة النفسية لدى الأطفال المتأثرين بالطلاق في السياق المحلي، وهو ما يتيح تصميم برامج تدخلية علاجية ووقائية أكثر فعالية.
- بذلك، يتجاوز البحث مجرد تأكيد النتائج المعروفة عالمياً، ليقدم إضافة معرفية متخصصة تساهم في فهم وتلبية احتياجات الأطفال المتأثرين بالطلاق بدقة وشمولية.

الكلمات المفتاحية: المرونة النفسية، أزمة الطلاق، الأطفال.